



NRAI

shooter or a team over the years, and it would get increasingly exciting. And while all of these are on the drawing board, the idea is not to take away from the purity of the Olympic sport as well.

The viewership of Olympic sports is on the rise. But then again, a recently revived sporting league hit financial roadblocks just a few months after its return. Has the possibility of financial strain been a concern?

To get somewhere, we have to start the journey. Not to make an attempt would be a crime. In my opinion, leagues go into a downward spiral when you take an opposition view to your stakeholders, be it the athletes or franchises. The NRAI has decided to take the view of a partnership with our franchises and athletes. That's a win-win for everybody. We are not looking to bring money in on the first day. We believe we will create something

different with a reasonable amount of value. We are not setting our expectations so high that we destroy the value to begin with.

Could you share some details regarding the owners of the franchises? The prospectus mentions at least six franchises, but earlier in this interaction, you mentioned four. Has it been difficult getting people on board?

No. We have positive talks going on with a number of potential franchise owners. Some of them own many teams across other sports. Some are individual buyers but command a lot of credibility.

Will the league eventually look at multiple venues, or would that become a logistical challenge?

No, it's possible. Currently, around 15,000 people are shooting across three major venues. But it does increase the cost for a franchise. So, we want to start with a lean model to

make sure that the league becomes a success in the long run. The vision is long-term and not running it for a year or two before packing up and going home. We understand we've got to work with the franchises to help them break even as quickly as possible while realising the value is not in the cash flow but more in the valuation of the asset going ahead.

The NRAI elections are scheduled in September, and the league is set to happen after that. Could that interfere with the organisation of the league? Has there been any effort to postpone the elections?

No, the elections will be held as per law. I don't see any reason why the election should interfere with the league. We have kept the management and vendors of the league outside the NRAI format. And it's going to be done professionally. I'm certain whoever is in the seat of power then will carry on the work.

It's understood that Gagan Narang was approached to be the face of the league, but couldn't sign up owing to prior commitments. Are there other veteran shooters being considered for the same role?

We have asked all our past Olympians and shooting legends to be involved, be it as a mentor, technical specialist, or merely to give us suggestions. It's important that those who have contributed and gotten glory from the sport should give back to it in different ways, and as a federation, it is our job to ensure that we open up avenues for them to be able to contribute.

To conclude the interview, can you provide some exclusive information on the league...

(Laughs) In 25-metre pistol, we can't do rapid fire because women can't participate.

So, we're doing a duelling stage, which is going to be the Olympic format after 2028. For 50m 3 positions, members of the same team will be shooting all the positions simultaneously. It will save time.